

Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

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| Candidate surname                                                                                        | Other names                                                                         |
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| Centre Number                                                                                            | Candidate Number                                                                    |
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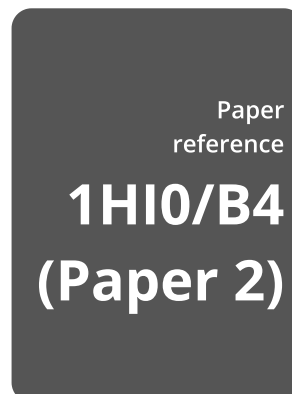
## Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9-1)

**Thursday 4 June 2026**

Morning (Time: 1 hour 50 minutes -  
total time for **both** booklets)

**History**

**BOOKLET B4: Early Elizabethan England,  
1558-88**



**You must have:**

The corresponding booklet P.

Total Marks

### Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- There are two booklets in this question paper. **This is booklet B.**
- Answer questions 1(a), 1(b), 2 and **either 3 or 4** in this booklet.
- Check you have the corresponding booklet P.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided  
- *there may be more space than you need.*

### Information

- The total mark for this booklet is 32.

- The total time for **both** booklets is 1 hour 50 minutes.
- The marks for **each** question are shown in brackets  
*- use this as a guide as to how much time to spend on each question.*
- **Do not forget to complete booklet P.**

## Advice

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Try to divide your time equally between each booklet of the question paper.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

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**Turn over ► Pearson**

**Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88**

**Answer Question 1(a), Question 1(b), Question 2 and EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.**

**1** (a) Describe one feature of the Ridolfi Plot (1571). (2)

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(b) Describe one feature of the Throckmorton Plot (1583). (2)

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**(Total for Question 1 = 4 marks)**

2 Explain why relations between England and Spain declined in the years 1568-1585. (12)

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- Religious differences
- Francis Drake's attacks on Spanish treasure

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

**Turn over ►**



**(Total for Question 2 = 12 marks)**  
*Turn over ►*

**Answer EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.**

**EITHER**

- 3** "The Northern Earls' Rebellion (1569) was a serious threat to Elizabeth."

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- Mary, Queen of Scots
- Lack of foreign support

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

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**(Total for Question 3 = 16 marks)**

**OR**

- 4** "The voyages of exploration in Elizabeth's reign were primarily motivated by a desire for wealth."

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- Trade routes
- Rivalry with Spain

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

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**(Total for Question 4 = 16 marks)**

Chosen question number: Question 3 ☐ Question 4 ☐

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**TOTAL FOR BOOKLET B = 32 MARKS**

**PLEASE ENSURE YOU ALSO COMPLETE BOOKLET P.**

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**DO NOT WRITE ON THIS PAGE**